



AI BLOG FACTORY

THE AI RESUME BUILDER

Resumes, LinkedIn & Job Applications That Get Responses

By Joy Roy | Founder, AI Blog Factory | 2026

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Why Your Resume Isn't Working

Here's what nobody tells you: your resume isn't a history of what you've done. It's a sales document designed to answer one question — why should this person interview you?

Most student resumes fail because they read like a diary. 'I studied X. I did Y. I learned Z.' Recruiters don't care what you learned. They care what you can do for them.

This book teaches you to think — and write — like someone who already has the job you want.

— Joy Roy, AI Blog Factory

CHAPTER 1

The ATS System

Why 75% of resumes never reach a human — and how to be in the 25% that do.

You spent 20 hours perfecting your resume. A recruiter spent 6 seconds on it. Those 6 seconds weren't spent reading — a robot scanned it first, decided it wasn't relevant, and deleted it. Welcome to Applicant Tracking Systems.

Understanding ATS is the single biggest upgrade you can make to your job search.

How ATS Actually Works

- ◆ Scans for keywords matching the job description
- ◆ Parses your content into categories (skills, experience, education)
- ◆ Scores your resume 1-100 based on match quality
- ◆ Only top scorers (usually top 20%) get human eyes

The ATS Cheat Code

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Step 1: Copy the entire job description into ChatGPT
Step 2: Ask: 'Extract the 15 most important keywords'
Step 3: Mirror these keywords EXACTLY in your resume
        (same wording, not synonyms)
Step 4: Place keywords in a 'Core Skills' section at top
Step 5: Repeat key phrases 2-3 times across the resume
```

I was applying to 50 jobs a month with zero responses. Started mirroring job description keywords. Got 8 interview calls in two weeks.

Ankit, 3rd Year CS

Resume Architecture

The structural formula that makes every bullet point count.

Your resume has three hours of a recruiter's attention at best (across all applicants). Structure is everything.

The STAR-X Formula

Go beyond STAR. Add the X — your personal contribution:

Letter	Means	Example
S	Situation	Second-year CS student at XYZ University
T	Task	Build a data pipeline for a real client
A	Action	Designed Python ETL with pandas, used ChatGPT to debug
R	Result	Reduced processing time by 40%, saved 10 hrs/week
X	YOU	Sole developer. Delivered in 3 days. Client renewed.

The 5-Second Test

Show your resume to a friend for 5 seconds. Then ask: 'What do I do? What am I good at?' If they can't answer, your headline needs work.

PLAY: ACTION VERB LIST

Built, Created, Led, Analyzed, Optimized, Designed, Delivered, Launched, Automated, Reduced, Increased, Managed, Developed.

WEAK: Helped, Worked on, Was responsible for, Assisted with.

LinkedIn as Your Public Resume

Recruiters Google you before they read you. Control what they find.

The Headline Formula

Replace 'Student at XYZ University' with:

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[Field] Student | [Skill 1] | [Skill 2] | [What you build/create]
```

EXAMPLES:

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Data Science Student | Python & ML | Building AI solutions
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Marketing Student | SEO & Content | Growing brand audiences
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Mechanical Student | CAD & Prototyping | Designing for manufacture
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Content Strategy for Students

You don't need years of experience to post. Share:

- ◆ Weekly learnings ('This week I learned X and here's what surprised me')
- ◆ Project walkthroughs ('How I built [thing] in [timeframe]')
- ◆ Career reflections ('3 things I wish I knew in my first year')

Cover Letter 3.0

The 3-paragraph framework that gets responses — because it never sounds like a template.

Most cover letters are lazy. 'I am writing to apply for...' Recruiters hear this 500 times a day. Yours needs to be different.

The Hook-Story-Action Framework

Paragraph	Purpose	Formula
1. Hook	Grab attention	Start with a specific achievement or insight about THEIR company
2. Story	Prove you're different	One concrete example of relevant work with numbers
3. Action	Tell them what to do next	Propose a specific next step: 'I'd love to discuss...'

PLAY: PROOF POINTS

Use numbers everywhere you can:

'Led a team of 4' > 'Led a team'

'Increased engagement by 47%' > 'Increased engagement'

'Delivered in 3 days ahead of deadline' > 'Delivered on time'

Portfolio = Proof

Projects speak louder than grades. Here's how to present yours.

A recruiter seeing a GitHub link with three active repositories will choose you over a candidate with a 9.0 GPA and no projects. Proof beats promise.

The GitHub Profile Check

- ◆ Profile picture (professional, or a clean avatar)
- ◆ Bio: 2 lines. Who you are. What you build.
- ◆ Pinned repos: 3-6 best projects with good READMEs
- ◆ Contribution graph: green is good, consistency is better

README = Your Project's Resume

Every project README should answer: What does this do? Why did I build it? What did I learn? How can someone run it?

CHAPTER 6

The Application System

Track. Follow up. Customize. Win.

Application Tracker

Don't apply to jobs and forget. Track every application:

Column	What to Track
Company & Role	Job title, posting link, date applied
Customization	What you changed in this application
Follow-up Date	Usually 4-5 business days after applying
Status	Applied → Screening → Interview → Offer → Rejected
Notes	Screeener name, interview dates, feedback

The Follow-Up Formula

SUBJECT: [Role] application – following up

Hi [Name],

I applied for [Role] on [Date]. I'm very interested because [specific reason tied to their work/news/mission].

I'd welcome a brief conversation if you're still reviewing applications. Either way, thank you for your time.

Best,
[Your Name]

Templates and Swipe Files

15 resume bullets. 10 LinkedIn headlines. 5 cover letter starters. All ready to customize.

RESUME BULLETS

- ◆ Built a [type] system using [tool] that improved [metric] by [x]%
- ◆ Led a team of [N] to deliver [project] [timeframe] ahead of schedule
- ◆ Analyzed [X] rows of data using Python to identify [insight], saving [amount]
- ◆ Created [content type] strategy that increased [metric] by [X]%
- ◆ Automated [process] using [tool], reducing time spent by [X] hours/week

LINKEDIN HEADLINES

- ◆ CS Student | AI & Python | Turning data into decisions
- ◆ Marketing Student | Storytelling + Data | Growing what matters
- ◆ Design Student | UX & Figma | Making tech feel human
- ◆ Finance Student | Excel & Python | Numbers with narratives
- ◆ EE Student | IoT & Embedded | Building connected systems

COVER LETTER STARTERS

- ◆ [Company]'s recent work on [specific project] resonated with me because...
- ◆ As someone who built [project] for [audience], I was immediately drawn to...
- ◆ Your job description mentioned [specific requirement]. Here's how I've done exactly that:...

YOUR NEXT INTERVIEW IS COMING.

The right resume. The right LinkedIn. The right application. Now you have all three.

Stop applying. Start getting responses.

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